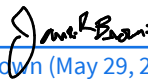


**James R. Brown**  
Jeanne & John R. Blocker Chair in Business Administration  
Professor and Department Head

## MEMORANDUM

**TO:** Farshid Abdi, Assistant Professor, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

**FROM:** Jamie Brown, Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance   
[Jamie Brown \(May 29, 2025 23:46 CDT\)](#)

**SUBJECT:** Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

Both Texas A&M University and Mays Business School require that the performance of all faculty be reviewed on an annual basis. As noted in the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines, the purposes of the annual performance review include:

- Creating a sound and logical basis for merit compensation recommendations
- Providing evaluative feedback regarding how well the individual is currently performing
- Providing developmental feedback regarding areas where the faculty member's contribution may be enhanced and/or improved in the future
- Providing feedback regarding progress toward promotion and/or tenure as relevant

Further, the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *excellence*;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *effective* performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *effective* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *needs improvement* performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *excellent*, *effective*, and *needs improvement* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *unsatisfactory* performance.

This letter serves as your performance review for the 2024 calendar year. The following reflects information provided in your Faculty 180 submission. In addition, the tenured Finance faculty had the opportunity to review your annual report (containing detailed information about your research, teaching, and service) and current resume and provided me with their assessment and feedback. In the sections below, I first briefly summarize the main contributions you have made in each area, present the assessment of the tenured faculty, and provide my own independent assessment.

## Research

Highlights of your research activity during the three-year evaluation window include:

- A revise and resubmit at *Management Science*, a top 5 finance journal.
- Four working papers with one paper single authored.
- Several presentations at strong conferences and workshops, including the AFA annual meeting.
- No new journal publications.
- 83 new Google Scholar citations in 2024, bringing your total citation count to more than 400.

## Teaching

- Consistently high student evaluations, with strong positive student comments and ratings greater than 4.6 out of 5.
- Review of your teaching materials and exams demonstrated competent, rigorous instruction.

## Service

- Member of the Faculty Senate at University of Massachusetts.
- Co-organizer, Microstructure Study Group in the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance.
- Referee for top journals, including *Management Science* and the *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*.

## Tenured Faculty Assessment

As you will see below, 9 of the 9 tenured faculty who reviewed your materials rated your research performance as “effective.” We are pleased that you have resubmitted your paper to *Management Science*. In addition to the *Management Science* paper, you will need at least two more publications in premier finance journals by the time you go up for tenure if your case is to succeed. Your PAR also notes that you have additional working papers that can further bolster your case for tenure and promotion.

The faculty encourages you to get more papers under review. The long lead time in the publication process implies that you should start getting your papers under review.

Your teaching evaluations indicate a high degree of student satisfaction. We also see no evidence to suggest the high student satisfaction is coming at the expense of rigor, so we have every reason to believe you are teaching an excellent course.

## Ratings (votes) from Tenured Faculty

**Research:** Effective (9)

**Teaching:** Excellent (9)

**Service:** Effective (9)

**As a colleague:** Excellent (9)

**Overall:** Effective (9)

## Additional Comments from Tenured Faculty

- He needs to submit more papers to journals to push them forward.
- Very good pipeline of research papers with numerous papers presented at national finance conferences as well as invited papers at universities and the Federal Reserve.
- Excellent teaching based on student evaluations and review of course materials, including syllabus, lecture notes and examples, assignments/projects, and exams.

### Department Head Assessment

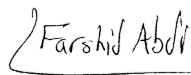
I agree with the assessment of the tenured faculty. You have several promising research projects in process, including the revise and resubmit at *Management Science*. It is important that you covert the MS paper and get the other papers under review as soon as possible. Your mid-term review of progress to promotion to Association Professor with tenure is scheduled for Fall 2026, which will be here before you know it. Converting the MS paper and moving the other papers forward will put you on track for a favorable mid-term review but given the low acceptance rates and long turnaround times at the top journals, you have a lot of work to do to build a tenurable record by the time of your mandatory P&T review in 2028-29.

I fully support your goals for 2025 of conducting impactful research and continuing to deliver effective teaching. I also appreciate your continued active engagement in department service, particularly related to tenure-track hiring, engagement with the PhD program, and work organizing the department seminar series. However, I encourage you to not let these service activities unnecessarily detract you from moving your own research forward.

Thank you very much for your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

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Please acknowledge receipt of this evaluation by signing below. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.



Farshid Abdi

05/30/2025

Date

# Abdi 2024 Annual Review

Final Audit Report

2025-05-30

|                              |                                              |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
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